him actually contribute in the end to Bhagat Singh's death at the hands of Lord Irwin? One needs only look at two specific pieces of evidence.

First, after the governor-general in council had rejected the petition of mercy for Bhagat Singh, Home Secretary, H.W. Emerson met with Mahatma Gandhi on 19 March 1931. A recent commentary by Utpal Aich, a diplomat who served as the first secretary in the Indian embassy in Addis Ababa, is revealing.[3] Aich takes the view that with the execution now more likely than not, what we learn from Emerson's minutes of that meeting, as reproduced in Volume XLV of the *Collected Works of Mahatma Gandhi* (CWMG)[4], is that he told Gandhi that 'the question as to whether it should take place before or after the Karachi Congress had been very seriously considered by Government who realized the difficulties of either course'. This, according to Emerson's note (which is produced in that volume at p. 440), would have been 'unfair to the condemned persons to postpone execution' but curiously 'also not fair to Gandhi'. What is startling about this account, however, is that Emerson records of Gandhi, 'He agreed that of the two alternatives it is better not to wait, but he suggested, *though not seriously*, that the third course of commutation of the sentence would have been better still. *He did not seem to me to be particularly concerned about the matter* . . .' (emphases added). Why, on a matter as serious as saving the life of Bhagat Singh, is Emerson suggesting here that Gandhi was not serious about the commutation of the sentence of death on Bhagat Singh and his comrades? And, why does Emerson record that Gandhi was not particularly concerned about this issue? In fact, it does not end there because Emerson then goes on to say of Gandhi in the same breath, 'I asked him to do all that he could to prevent meetings being held in Delhi . . . *He promised to do what he could*' (emphases added).[5] Why is Gandhi agreeing in the aftermath of Bhagat Singh's execution to actively assist Emerson in the maintenance of law and order? If what Emerson writes is correct, then this is truly extraordinary because it shows the Mahatma being in active discussions with Irwin about how Bhagat Singh should be executed. This is a grave charge, which is why it must be pointed out that Gandhi's own version of his personal meeting with Emerson is not reproduced in the